

‘We have lost our village’



JEAN-CHRISTOPHE BOTT/EPA-EFE/SHUTTERSTOCK

The Swiss Alps village of Blatten was left almost completely buried by an avalanche that also blocked a river, causing severe flooding. Residents had been evacuated as geologists warned that a glacier was ready to collapse. **Story, A10**

As Trump pushes boundaries, Roberts holds to his own

BY ANN E. MARIMOW

Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. is navigating a fraught path, legal analysts say, trying to avert a direct confrontation between the Trump administration and a Supreme Court that has steadily expanded presidential power — but not without limits.

The stakes are as high as at any time in Roberts’s 20-year tenure. He is committed to protecting the independence of the courts to “check the excesses of Congress

Chief justice alternately seen as deft, enabling as he seeks to avert face-off

or the executive,” as he said recently, amid attacks by President Donald Trump and his allies on federal judges, including the justices.

Since Trump returned to the White House, the Supreme Court

has granted him most, but not all, of what he asked for in emergency requests. The justices have allowed the administration for now to bar transgender troops from the military, fire independent agency leaders without cause, halt teacher grants and remove protections for as many as 350,000 Venezuelans.

The notable, increasingly forceful exceptions have come in cases involving the due process rights of migrants targeted for fast-tracked deportation.

It is still early in Trump’s term to draw conclusions about how the Supreme Court will ultimately rule on the many lawsuits challenging the administration’s most aggressive moves. Over the next few years, the justices could have the final word on issues including tariffs, birthright citizenship, the firing of independent agency leaders and more.

In handling the flood of emergency requests so far, Roberts seems to be taking a page from

SEE COURT ON A4

Some at Harvard are reporting visa denials, a university official says

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA

A federal judge Thursday blocked the Trump administration’s attempt to bar international students from enrolling at Harvard.

U.S. District Judge Allison D. Burroughs said a temporary restraining order she issued last week must remain in place until a preliminary injunction is issued. The judge’s order, which was

issued on the school’s commencement day, grants Harvard a win in one of the most high-stakes battles in its ongoing war with the administration.

“Today’s court decision allows the University to continue enrolling international students and scholars while the case moves forward,” Jason Newton, a spokesperson for the school, said in an emailed statement. “Harvard will continue to take steps to protect the rights of our international students and scholars, members of our community who are vital to the University’s academic excellence.”

SEE HARVARD ON A6

Graduation: Harvard celebrates in shadow of fight with Trump. **A6**

Justices narrow scope of U.S. environmental reviews

8-0 ruling limits federal scrutiny required for infrastructure projects

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL AND MAXINE JOSELOW

The Supreme Court on Thursday unanimously narrowed the scope of government-required environmental reviews for major infrastructure projects, overturning a lower-court block on a rail line in Utah that would carry billions of gallons of oil.

The case became a proxy battle over how far federal agencies may go in assessing the environmental impact of highways, pipelines and other projects before deciding whether to approve them.

Business interests cheered the ruling as a necessary check on a process that had become too burdensome, costly and slow, while environmentalists said it would allow agencies to ignore major environmental impacts, including the acceleration of climate change.

An array of challengers spent years battling over the 88-mile stretch of track that would connect the remote Uinta Basin in northeastern Utah to national rail lines, allowing the extraction of more waxy crude oil from one of the nation’s largest oil fields.

The high court’s ruling returns the case to the lower court for

further review under more limited parameters. It remains unclear whether the rail line will ultimately be built.

The decision adds to a string of rulings by the high court that have sharply curtailed environmental regulation. In March, the justices struck down rules regulating the discharge of water pollution. Last term, in a landmark ruling, the Supreme Court overturned a 40-year-old precedent that formed the basis of thousands of environmental regulations, allowing some long-settled rules to be challenged in court. The conservative supermajority also has trimmed the power of the Environmental Protection Agency to regulate air pollution, runoff in wetlands and greenhouse gases.

The Utah rail project, which could result in a large increase in greenhouse gas emissions, was approved by the Surface Transportation Board in 2021, with the federal panel saying the benefits of the line would outweigh the negative impacts.

Five environmental groups and the county that is home to Vail, Colorado, challenged that decision before the U.S. Court of Appeals for the D.C. Circuit. The appeals court ruled that the transportation board failed to fully examine the effects of increased drilling in the Uinta Basin and the pollution caused by refining the crude oil on the Gulf Coast, as required by the National Environmental Policy Act.

SEE RULING ON A4



ALLISON ROBERT/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

After tragedy, Jewish museum reopens

Harold Greenberg covers his eyes in prayer at the Capital Jewish Museum, which welcomed visitors for a ceremony eight days after the killing of two Israeli Embassy staffers. **Story, B1**

Starship failure puts moon timeline in question

BY JOEL ACHENBACH

NASA hopes to put astronauts on the moon in just two years, but a critical spacecraft required for the mission keeps exploding or disintegrating: SpaceX’s Starship, the largest rocket ever built. Originally envisioned as a Mars rocket, it is also a key piece of

NASA’s plan to outpace China and land humans on the lunar surface for the first time in more than half a century.

On its ninth launch Tuesday, the 403-foot-tall Starship managed to reach space, but as it reentered the atmosphere, it began to tumble out of control and broke apart. The two previous

Starship launches ended in explosions over the Caribbean.

The consecutive failures may have decreased the likelihood SpaceX can meet NASA’s 2027 goal, observers said, a schedule that has already been questioned as overly ambitious.

Aerospace experts did not agree

SEE STARSHIP ON A12

Clemency for ex-gangster, rapper, former congressmen

BY EMILY DAVIES

A gang leader who built a powerful criminal enterprise, an ex-congressman from New York who underreported earnings from his Manhattan restaurant and a Connecticut governor toppled in a corruption scandal all received clemency in a sweeping series of orders signed by President Donald Trump.

Trump extended relief Wednesday to 25 people whose crimes spanned decades and included tax evasion and extortion, according to the department.

The recipients — 17 of whom received pardons and eight, commutations — all had felony convictions, like Trump, and could see an array of benefits, including restoration of voting rights and release from imprisonment. The White House did not respond to questions about how Trump selected the individuals.

Since reclaiming the White House, Trump has deployed pardons in a wide-reaching campaign to recalibrate a justice system he calls corrupt and says politically persecuted him. Some of those pardoned were convicted of crimes similar to charges brought against him or his family business. Others repeatedly flexed their loyalty to his administration.

SEE PARDONS ON A7

IN THE NEWS

Musk exits government The billionaire’s contentious tenure overseeing DOGE comes to an end, leaving behind memorable moments and a tarnished legacy. **A5**

A new way to pay After Metro fumbled a plan to allow riders to use credit cards at the gate a decade ago, the technology is finally here. **B1**

THE NATION **ICE detained** a Venezuelan singer who begged not to be deported in a viral song. **A3**
Women are suing Kansas over a law nullifying pregnant people’s end-of-life wishes. **A6**

THE WORLD **With Iran’s help**, Russia has updated its deadly drone capabilities, a report says. **A8**
The Earth will pass a critical climate threshold of warming by 2027, scientists say. **A10**

THE ECONOMY **Ethics experts** are raising eyebrows at President Donald Trump’s deepening ties to the crypto industry. **A11**
The president met with the Fed chair for the first time this term, after publicly pressuring him last month to slash rates. **A12**

THE REGION **A lawsuit** in Maryland contends that closed primary elections are unconstitutional by violating rights of voters not registered to a party. **B1**
The historians who have recorded U.S. foreign policy since 1861 were fired by the Trump administration. **B1**

SPORTS **Commanders** offensive coordinator Kliff Kingsbury has a good problem: Keeping all his talented players happy. **D1**
WEEKEND **These D.C.-area** dining destinations welcome hungry revelers with LGBTQ+ festivities during WorldPride.

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